publicity, the Viceroy Lord Irwin was keen to find a way out. By January 1931, Gandhi was released from custody. Two men now set about discussing a negotiated settlement of their dispute, in eight meetings involving twenty-four hours. Gandhi undertook to relinquish his quest for satyagraha and Lord Irwin agreed to release all those who had been imprisoned during the protests. Indians were also to be allowed to make salt for domestic use. Winston Churchill, together with others in the British establishment back in London, was incensed and scandalized '. . . at the nauseating and humiliating spectacle of this one-time Inner Temple lawyer, now seditious fakir, striding half-naked up the steps of the Viceroy's, there to negotiate and parley on equal terms with the representative of the King Emperor'.[10] However, Gandhi saw satyagraha as a 'non-violent struggle', with the emphasis being on self-suffering at the hands of an oppressor, thus making it morally impracticable for the oppression to continue indefinitely. However, modern-day criticism, such as from Justice Katju, is that what this succeeded in doing was 'diverting the genuine revolutionary independence struggle against the British in India to harmless . . . channels like "Satyagrah"'.[11]

As for Subhas Chandra Bose, in a separate chapter on 'The Gandhi-Irwin Pact And After (1931),' [12] he explains how the terms of this pact included on the one hand 'the suspension by Mahatma Gandhi of the Civil Disobedience Movement' and 'the participation in the deliberations of the forthcoming conference for drafting a constitution for India on the basis of Federation' while on the other hand, on the part of the viceroy of India, it included a concomitant undertaking 'to release simultaneously all political prisoners incarcerated in connection with the non-violent movement' as well as 'to withdraw the emergency ordinances'. While it is certainly true that Bhagat Singh was not seen as a prominent exponent of the non-violent movement, it was equally the case that he was being tried as the most famous revolutionary freedom-fighter known in India at the time, under emergency ordinances, namely, the Lahore Ordinance No. 3 of 1930. In the circumstances, therefore, one would have expected Mahatma Gandhi to insist on his release precisely because that release fell within the terms of